# Lion -- Elevation Worship (CCM / Modern Worship)

HSS Stratocaster. Full board.
Album-level build, modeled on the overall guitar approach across Elevation Worship's *Lion* (2022) and their wider catalog -- the modern CCM "wall of sound": ambient, heavily modulated clean tones under verses, swelling into a bigger, saturated anthem tone for choruses and lead lines, all of it soaked in delay and reverb the whole time.
That wash never goes away between the two states -- only the gain does. That's the core design decision here: MOD/DLY/RVB/EQ and the amp/cab stay fixed and always on, CTL only swaps the gain stages.

## GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

**AMP -- Foxy 30TB** (always on)
- Gain: 32, Tone Cut: 40, VOL: 60, Bass: 45, Treble: 62, Char: Cool
- The GP-5's model of the Vox AC30HW Top Boost channel. Modern worship lives on a chimey AC30.
- Gain 32: clean with a little edge. The Boost, Green OD and King of Kings supply the anthem gain.
- Tone Cut 40 and Treble 62: bright and chimey. The EQ's 3kHz/6kHz lift adds the shimmer on top.
- Bass 45: a little lean, so it doesn't fight bass and pads.
- Char Cool: the cleaner of the two voicings. Hot would pile more gain under the OD stack.
- Moved off the WorshipAC30 snaptone 2026-10-01. Michael dropped the AC30 NAMs until a better one turns up, so this uses the GP-5's own AC30 model.
- Same in both CTL states.

**CAB -- User IR 10: V30112** (always on)
- VOL: 60
- Celestion V30 1x12 IR from the loaded set, the same cab as the other Elevation Worship patches (Praise). It's tight and mid-forward, so it cuts through a dense worship mix.
- Same in both CTL states.

**NR -- Gate**
- THRE: 20
- Always on. Light -- this patch lives on long decaying swells and delay/reverb tails, so the gate can't be aggressive enough to chop them off.

**PRE -- Boost** (Xotic EP Booster)
- Gain: 60, +3dB: On, Bright: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- The "size" switch for the anthem state -- clean, transparent volume/edge boost that pushes the amp and DST harder without adding its own character. Off for the ambient rhythm sound, on for the lead/chorus lift.

**DST -- Green OD** (Tube Screamer / TS-808)
- Gain: 40, Tone: 60, VOL: 65

- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Moderate, not metal -- this is the smooth, singing mid-gain crunch that defines the modern worship "anthem" guitar tone, not a rock distortion. Off for rhythm, on for lead, stacking with the Boost and the King of Kings right channel (see pedalboard) for the full swell.

**EQ -- Guitar EQ 2**
- 100Hz: -3, 500Hz: -2, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +4, 6kHz: +5, VOL: 50
- Always on. Low end trimmed so the guitar doesn't fight bass/pads in a dense worship mix; slight 500Hz cut to keep it out of the boxy zone; 3kHz/6kHz lifted for the airy, cutting shimmer that sits on top of a big band mix without needing raw volume.

**MOD -- A-Chorus** (Arion SCH-1)
- Depth: 55, Rate: 0.6Hz, Tone: 60
- Loads on, both CTL states. MIDI toggle: loads on, can be switched off (see MIDI toggles). Heavier than this workflow's usual light-touch MOD default -- deliberately, because a drenched, obvious chorus shimmer is the whole point of this style, not an accident. This is doing a lot of the "ambient wall" work by itself.

**DLY -- Tape**
- Mix: 35, Time: 450ms, F.Back: 35, Trail: On
- Loads on, both CTL states. MIDI toggle: loads on, can be switched off (see MIDI toggles). Long, warm, saturated repeats -- this genre's guitar sound is inseparable from delay. Same delay under both the quiet rhythm parts and the big lead swells, which is exactly how these records are built.

**RVB -- Sweet Space**
- Mix: 40, Decay: 70, Damp: 40, Mod: 35, Trail: On
- Always on, both CTL states. Long, modulated, spacious reverb -- the Mod parameter adds a subtle shimmer/movement to the tail that's very characteristic of this modern-CCM ambient sound. This is the "room" the whole track lives in.

### CTL Summary (GP-5)
- **CTL Off -- Rhythm (verses, ambient sections):** Clean, chimey AC30 tone, no PRE boost, no drive. The wash (chorus/delay/reverb) carries the sound. This is the main texture of the patch.
- **CTL On -- Lead (choruses, anthem sections):** Boost + Green OD both kick in on top of the same amp/cab/wash, pushing into a bigger, saturated, sustained tone -- same ambient character, just louder and driven. Pair with the King of Kings right channel for the full swell.

## MIDI toggles

MIDI = True (added 2026-10-12). With no MIDI controller connected, the patch loads and plays exactly as before: CTL and the board work the same. MIDI adds single-block toggles on top.

On MIDI: PRE (Boost), DST (Green OD), MOD (A-Chorus), DLY (Tape). PRE and DST are also on CTL. MOD and DLY are MIDI-only and load on.

Sounds:

- **Clean wash** (default). CTL off, all MIDI blocks as loaded. Verses and ambient sections.
- **Driven rhythm.** CTL off, MIDI DST on. The Green OD alone, no boost: mid-gain strummed rhythm for second verses and builds, before the anthem.
- **Dry tight strum.** CTL off, MIDI DLY off, MIDI MOD off. Rhythmic strumming and up-tempo songs where the wash smears the groove.
- **Anthem lead** (CTL on). Boost + Green OD over the full wash. Choruses and anthem sections.
- **Soft lead.** CTL on, MIDI PRE off. The Green OD without the boost: a quieter, smoother lead for bridges and intimate melody lines.
- **Shared CTL/MIDI blocks:** before pressing CTL, switch any CTL block you changed by MIDI back to how it was. I haven't confirmed whether the GP-5's CTL flips each block or sets it to a fixed state, and doing this gives the right result either way. Changing a block by MIDI *after* pressing CTL is always safe.

## Full Pedalboard (signal chain order)

**1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Engaged, light shimmer layer, whole song.**

- +OCT: 25, all other octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +2OCT): 0
- Dry: 80

A subtle octave-up layer underneath the dry signal -- this is a real Elevation Worship production trick, a quiet shimmer pad sitting under the clean arpeggios. Kept low enough (+OCT 25) that it reads as texture, not a separate voice. Since it's polyphonic and best on sustained material, it works well here because this patch is built around sustained chords and swells, not fast lead runs.

**2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged, whole song.**

- COMP: 50
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: NORMAL

Evens out dynamics for sustained ambient swells -- critical for this style, where notes need to bloom and hold evenly under all that delay/reverb. NORMAL mode (not TREBLE) because the EQ module and MOD/DLY/RVB chain already add plenty of top end; stacking more brightness pre-drive would get harsh once the Boost/Green OD kick in.

**3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed, whole song.**

Not a fuzz style -- the anthem lift comes from smooth, singing overdrive (Boost + Green OD + King of Kings), not garage fuzz character. True bypass throughout.

**4. Joyo King of Kings -- Left channel engaged whole song, Right channel engaged only for CTL On / lead sections.**

*Left channel (always on -- low-gain glue):*

- Volume: 55
- Gain: 20
- Tone: 55

- Clipping toggle: softer setting
- Feedback toggle: standard setting

A quiet, always-on push that adds warmth and a little extra harmonic content under the clean ambient tone -- very common in modern worship rigs, an always-on low-gain stage that "glues" the tone even before anything else engages.

*Right channel (CTL On / lead only):*
- Volume: 65
- Gain: 55
- Tone: 60
- Clipping toggle: harder setting
- Feedback toggle: higher setting

Stacks with the left channel, the GP-5's Boost, and Green OD for the full anthem swell -- this is the extra saturation and sustain that makes the chorus/lead sections feel huge without turning harsh. Step on together with the GP-5 CTL switch.

**5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed, whole song.**
The GP-5's own A-Chorus (always on) is the primary chorus/shimmer voice for this patch, already pushed harder than usual on purpose. Stacking a second chorus pedal on top would turn the wash to mud. True bypass throughout.

**6. Valeton GP-5 -- as detailed above.**

## Footswitch Choreography

- **Rhythm / verses / ambient sections:** GP-5 CTL off, King of Kings right channel off. Comp and Octave shimmer running underneath the whole time.
- **Chorus / lead / anthem sections:** GP-5 CTL on (engages PRE Boost + Green OD together) at the same moment you step on the King of Kings right channel. All three come off together when dropping back to a verse/rhythm section.
- Fuzz and Narcissus stay bypassed for the entire patch -- the wash comes from the GP-5's own MOD/DLY/RVB, not from stacking extra modulation/fuzz pedals.